

Complaints and compliments

Our club is committed to providing a stimulating, consistent and accessible service to children and their parents/carers. We always aim to provide high quality services for everyone, but accept that sometimes things do not go according to plan. In such circumstances, we want to know, so that we can put them right and learn from our mistakes.

This policy constitutes the club's formal Complaints Procedure. It will be displayed on the premises at all times.

If you have a complaint, the club is committed to:

1. Listen and learn
2. Put things right
3. Improve our service

Under normal circumstances, the manager (Mandy Grosse) will be responsible for managing complaints. If a complaint is made against her then the deputy manager (Natalie Walton) will conduct the investigation. All complaints made to staff will be recorded in detail in the complaints file. The Owner will ensure that each complaint is fully investigated.

If the manager has good reason to believe that the situation has child protection implications, she will contact the local social care department, according to the procedure set out in the Safeguarding policy. If any party involved in the complaint has good reason to believe that a criminal offence has been committed, then the police will be contacted immediately.

Stage One

If a parent/carer has a complaint about some aspect of the club's activity, about the service the club provides, or about the conduct of a member of staff, it will often be possible to resolve the problem by simply speaking to the individual concerned. As outlined in the Partnership with Parents/Carers policy, the club is committed to open and regular dialogue with parents/carers and the club welcomes all comments on its services, regardless of whether they are positive or negative.

In the first instance, parents/carers are encouraged to speak directly to the relevant member of staff, if deemed appropriate. If not, the manager or the owner should be approached and they will try to resolve the problem. If a satisfactory resolution cannot be found, then Stage Two of the procedure will formally come into operation.

Stage Two

If informal discussions of a complaint or problem have not produced a satisfactory resolution to the situation, parents/carers should put their complaint in detail and in writing to the Owner. Relevant names, dates, evidence and any other important information on the nature of the complaint should be included.

The club will acknowledge receipt of the complaint within (3) three working days and will give you a response to your complaint within ten (10) working days. We shall explain what we are doing to resolve the issues you have raised if it will take longer than the 10 days to do this.

The Owner will be responsible for sending a full and formal response of the outcome of the investigation to the complaint – within 28 days of having received the complaint.

The formal response to the complaint from the club will be sent to the parent/carer concerned and copied to all relevant members of staff if appropriate. The response will include an account of the findings; any actions taken as a result, recommendations for dealing with the complaint and any amendments to the club's policies or procedures emerging from the investigation.

The Owner will arrange a time to meet the parent/carer concerned and any other relevant individuals, such as members of staff, to discuss the complaint and the club's response to it. The Owner will judge if it is best for all parties to meet together or if individual meetings are more appropriate.

If at the conclusion of this process parents/carers remain dissatisfied with the response they have received, the original complaint along with the club's response will be passed to the Owner who will adjudicate the case.

Records of all complaints and their outcome will be retained for a period of at least 3 years from when the record was made.

Parents will be allowed access to all written records about their children on request (except in exceptional cases).

As the Owner and the Registered person are the same person, parents/carers may have right of appeal to the Manager or deputy manager, or if necessary, take their complaint further by contacting OFSTED.

As part of the registration process of all early years and play provision by OFSTED parents/carers also have the right to make a complaint to OFSTED.

This can be done by ringing Tel: 0300 1234666
Or emailing: enquiries@ofsted.gov.uk

or writing to: OFSTED Early Years, Piccadilly Gate, Store Street, Manchester, M1 2WD.

www.ofsted.gov.uk

The club will also supply a copy of the most recent Ofsted report to parents/carers of children attending.

The club always welcome suggestions, feedback, and compliments too. A suggestion box is available and questionnaires will be sent out to ensure we are working with the parents within the community.

We are registered under the Children Act 89 (updated 2006) as an out of school childcare provider

Signed: position in club: Owner

Date: 15/01/2025 Review date: January 2026

I the undersigned, am signing to say that I have reviewed this policy with the team, and will adhere to the policy at all times.

A.Grosse: Date:

N.Walton: Date:

H.Bailey: Date:

T.Quinn: Date:

M.Wright: Date: